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Bundled up Fellows visiting Sinsila in East Jerusalem during last year's "Disorientation" week. With Sinsila Director Tareq Nasser, Matan Israeli, Director of Muslala and a visitor from Sweden.

JERUSALEM INTERNATIONAL FELLOWS

Dear <<First Name>>,

Happy International Women's Day! A year ago today, the first **Jerusalem International Fellows** residency began with four women - from Brazil, India, Mexico and the U.S.

It was the coldest Jerusalem in 100 years. (One of our first tasks was to make sure our Fellows had enough layers.) We began "Disorientation" week with an incredible tour of the Old City by the brilliant guide Dari Gil. Within a day, the complexities of the city became apparent. And they would continue to surprise and confuse our four Fellows.

Over the next 10 weeks, Vibha, Sofia, Claudia and Anna developed rich relationships with Israelis and Palestinians that continue today (more on some of those below.) They each created works that are still resonating and have spoken eloquently on the transformative

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effect Jerusalem had on them and their work.

One year later, the country is in a horrifying state. I had serious concerns about whether or not to continue the program. As always, I went to my Advisors and former Fellows for their perspective. To a person, they all agreed **"we must go forward, now more than ever."** They felt that the presence of international artists would be beneficial to the small, brave organizations fighting for democracy, artistic freedom and equal rights for ALL. (See more about the chilling situation facing artists, below.)

And so we continue. We will be announcing the next group of Host Organizations in the coming weeks and will then launch the global nominating process. We expect to select the next cohort of Fellows by or before September of 2023 for the Fall 2024 program.

We are grateful for recently received contributions from Anita and Marc Abramowitz, David Levine, JIF Advisors and many generous individuals. [Rich Buyer](#) provided essential assistance with our website. And we have received renewed pledges of support from Roselyn (Cissie) Swig and Bloomberg Philanthropies.

Will you join them making the 2024 residency even more impactful than this past one?

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2022 Fellow Vibha Galhotra.

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while she is in NY next month:

Save the Date!!

Monday evening, April 10th

location TBA

Information/invitation to follow



Artist and Bezalel Professor Sara Benninga

Last month an exhibit including a dear colleague and friend of our Fellows, Sara Benninga exemplified the fight for artistic freedom in Israel.

"Jerusalem Censored This Israeli's Nude Art, Then Denied It.

'Soon They'll Say There Was Never an Exhibit'

After the Jerusalem Municipality told Israeli artist Sara Benninga it would not display her art, which includes nude figures, in a municipal gallery, they denied censoring her. Now she wants to warn against shutting these conversations down."

You can read about the whole article in Ha'aretz [here](#).



Choreographer Claudia Lavista with choreographer and Head of the Movement Department at Jerusalem Academy of Music and Dance, Ronen Izhaki, with their students, together at Claudia's school in Mazatlan.

News from our Fellows:

Claudia Lavista (Fellow 2022) hosted a 2 week residency for 5 students from the Jerusalem Academy of Music and Dance (JAMD) at her Escuela Profesional de Danza de Mazatlán-EPDM/México. The exchange was so successful that she and Jerusalem choreographer Ronen Izhaki are planning for the Mexican students to visit JAMD in 2024!

[Subscribe](#)[Past Issues](#)[Learn more about these amazing sculptural works on his website.](#)[Translate ▼](#)

we will continue to upload photos, videos, and reflections from our Fellows. You can also enjoy photos and videos on our Instagram [@jerusaleminternationalfellows](#).

Press we have received for the 2022 residency can be found [here](#).

You can read the full evaluation of the program by On Track Consulting [here](#).

We welcome your questions and comments and look forward to telling and showing you more about our Fellows as their connections unfold.



Fellows at El Hakawati theater during "Disorientation" week.

If you are interested in artists, culture and the incredible City of Jerusalem, please support the future of this deeply meaningful, impactful cultural residency program.

Jl Fellows welcomes contributions at every level and we are grateful for all of them. Join our family of generous supporters and help the brave cultural organizations in city of Jerusalem make change with the help of our International Fellows.

Your tax-deductible gift can be made here and will reach Jerusalem International Fellows through the FJC Donor Advised Funds.

Abundant thanks to all of you who make this transformative program possible.

Best wishes,

Elise and the JIF team

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